

CDN Incident Alert: 0073. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	PL Coordinated Cross-Platform FIMI Campaign Targeting Polish Elections	03/06/2025

Summary

- A coordinated network of X accounts, most exhibiting unnatural behaviour, has been used to promote content from right-wing and far-right factions in Poland, exploiting TikTok's recommendation algorithms. The campaign leveraged TikTok's share function, enabling X-linked accounts to instantly repost TikTok videos to X.
- These same accounts also amplified content from pro-Russian and Belarusian state media on TikTok. The narrative promoted by the campaign claims that Poland is being destroyed by incompetent elites, corrupt politicians, and immigrants, while portraying the far right as the nation's only salvation.
- The behaviour reflects characteristics of an astroturfing campaign aimed at polarizing public opinion in Poland ahead of the elections. Tactics included algorithm manipulation, automated content-sharing bots, and strategic hashtag boosting - primarily in support of specific right-wing candidates.
- To counter the campaign's impact, it is recommended to conduct outreach efforts, including exposing the disinformation network through media partnerships and engaging young TikTok creators to build effective counter-narratives that can help break information bubbles and reduce the influence of disinformation.

Incident

Over 1,600 active X accounts were identified sharing content from more than 1,000 predominantly right-wing or far-right TikTok accounts. In 2025 alone, over 105,000 posts were published on X by more than 5,000 unique accounts, generating 218,000 impressions.

We believe the influence operation has been active on X (formerly Twitter) for over a year, peaking between January and March 2025 with up to 800 daily shares of TikTok videos. The accounts involved display clear signs of inauthentic behaviour—recent creation dates, low follower counts, and generic or stock profile images—indicating an organized campaign. In 2025 alone, over 105,000 posts were published on X by more than 5,000 unique accounts, generating 218,000 impressions.

These accounts predominantly promote right-wing and far-right political views in Poland. Hashtag analysis shows consistent ideological themes, including Euroscepticism, anti-migration sentiment, and a critical stance toward support for Ukraine. Content shared across TikTok and X often features politically inflammatory messages and borders on hate speech, in alignment with pro-Kremlin propaganda and misinformation.

Some of the most active X accounts also promoted Belarusian state media and problematic news outlets linked to the sanctioned titles such as “Voice of Europe.”

Similar tactics have been observed in other European countries with large TikTok audiences, including Romania and France. Notably, no comparable activity has been detected within Russia, despite its significantly larger TikTok user base.

Narrative

Meta narratives: Poland is being destroyed by incompetent, liberal elites, corrupt politicians and parasitic immigrants; only radical, far-right political change can save the country.

Sub-narratives: The current government is not fit for this job: the competence and legality of the current government are being questioned, as well as the competence of the presidential candidate R. Trzaskowski; Immigrants (Ukrainians, refugees from Africa) pose a threat to society: xenophobic, anti-Semitic and anti-refugee sentiments are used to promote specific political candidates;

Anti-EU attitude and threat from the West: presenting the EU, especially Germany, as hostile to Poland, promoting anti-EU candidates, primarily G. Braun.

Impact

Reach: Over 1600 X accounts identified in the sample; Over 1000 TikTok profiles shared by the X accounts in the automated way (724 labelled by AI as politically right/far-right, 63 as centre, 37 as left, 289 unclassified); In 2025, 105,000 posts on X were published by more than 5,000 unique accounts and received 218,000 impressions; At least 1,000 TikTok profiles are involved in the campaign, the real number is probably much higher.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0135.004: Polarise](#) – most of the shared content targets elections with polarising topics.
[T0121: Manipulate Platform Algorithm](#) – X accounts massively share TikTok videos to amplify their reach.
[T0049.003: Bots Amplify via Automated Forwarding and Reposting](#) – X accounts share features of being bots.
[T0049.002: Flood Existing Hashtag](#) – X accounts use generic text to share the content.
[T0074.002: Domestic Political Advantage](#) – TikTok videos are favourable to the right/far-right candidates.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Flagged case through the Code of Practice on Disinformation.

Recommendations: Engage journalists to expose disinformation campaigns and raise public awareness about the rise of hate speech and xenophobia on Polish social media, using concrete examples from TikTok; Encourage young, apolitical TikTok creators known for light-hearted content to launch humorous counter-campaigns mocking harmful narratives, and share this content widely across TikTok and other platforms.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
In prepara tion	Elections, Far- Right, Anti-EU	Evidence Sheet (on request)	Jakub Kubś, GLOBSEC Kamila Korońska, UvA	TikTok, X	